3.4 Radio-Ready Audio - The 90-Second Weapon That Forces Replies

Elite private strategy - not for redistribution

WAR-ROOM NOTES - 3.4 Radio-Ready Audio

THE LOGISTICS GAP IS THE BIGGEST UNTAPPED ADVANTAGE IN INDIE RADIO

The music that gets added is rarely the best music - it's the music that's easiest to add. A PD evaluating one file vs. a folder of five versions, one radio-loud edit vs. a master that's quieter than their station's bed, one 90-second argument vs. an unlabeled Dropbox: the gap isn't talent. It's friction. Radio-ready audio removes 100% of the friction so the decision is purely musical - and you win because your music was never the problem.

THE THREE-FILE FORMULA IS A SUPPLY-CHAIN, NOT A CHOICE

- 90-sec promo - the argument (hook, voice, story, CTA). This is what gets the first listen.
- Radio edit - the inventory (clean, loud, 3:00-3:45). This is what actually gets added.
- 30-sec payload - the derivative (beds, IDs, clips, social cutdowns). This is what the PD hands to the promotions team - and the moment a station's promo person forwards your 30-sec cutdown, you've graduated from "submission" to "material."

Produce all three before the first send. Every hour of production here saves 20 hours of campaign repair.

THE FRICTION SCORE (AUDIT YOURSELF)

Score each delivery element 0-2: (0) file exists but is buried in a folder; (1) file is linked but requires login/player; (2) file plays in one click with correct name and metadata. A PD-facing friction score of 8+ wins; 5 and below is a coin flip. This single metric predicts reply rate better than any genre or quality metric - because it predicts whether the PD ever listens.

THE 12-SECOND RULE APPLIES TO THE PROMO TOO

The promo's first 10 seconds are the hook - not an intro, not a "hey everyone," not a fade-in. Radio people sample. The 90-sec file must be sample-able: any 10 seconds of it should be enough to sell the song. If you can't randomly sample it, it's a song trailer, not a weapon.

THE METADATA GOLD MINE

Every file carries: artist, title, contact email, phone, city, release date, and a note "clean edit." When a PD forwards your file to a colleague - which they do - the metadata is your follow-up system working for free. A file without metadata is a file that dies on arrival. Tag everything. Always.